Brodsky and Pichler:

Baukunst on Paper

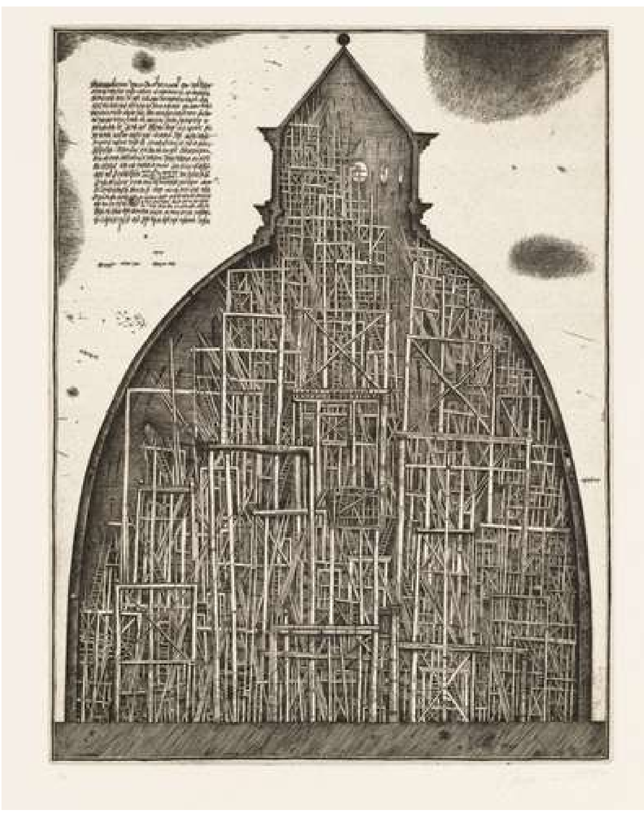

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Table of contents:

List of Illustrations

Figure 6. Dallegret, F. (1965) *A Home is not a House.* Available at: https://architecturaldialogue.wordpress.com/tag/house-is-not-a-home/ (Accessed: 22/11/2025)

Figure 7. Pichler, W. (1963) *Underground Building (Isometric).* [Ink and graphite] Available at: https://www.moma.org/collection/works/698 (Accessed: 17/11/2025)

Figure 8. Pichler, W. (1962) *Nucleus of Underground Building (Isometric).* [Graphite and coloring pencil] Available at: https://www.moma.org/collection/works/701?artist_id=4612&page=1&sov_referrer=artist (Accessed: 17/11/2025)

Figure 9. FRAC. *Compact City (Model)* by Walter Pichler (1964). [Plaster, brass, plastic, paint] Available at: https://collection.frac-centre.fr/artwork/5030000000009087?authID=149&ensembleID=467&page=2&filters=query%3Awalter%20pichler&note (Accessed: 19/11/2025)

Figure 10. Domusweb. (2002) *House next to the Smithy* by Walter Pichler (1999-2002) [Photography] Available at: https://www.domusweb.it/en/architecture/2002/08/26/an-artist-house-on-the-dolomites-walter-pichler-in-eggental-on-domus-at-the-turn-of-the-millennium.html (Accessed: 1/12/2025)

Figure 11. Pichler, W. (1999-2002) *House next to the Smithy concrete foundations (Isometric).* [Colored pencil and graphite] Available at: https://www.domusweb.it/en/architecture/2002/08/26/an-artist-house-on-the-dolomites-walter-pichler-in-eggental-on-domus-at-the-turn-of-the-millennium.html (Accessed: 1/12/2025)

Figure 12. Pichler, W. (1999-2002) *House next to the Smithy elevation.* [Colored pencil, charcoal, and graphite] Available at: https://www.domusweb.it/en/architecture/2002/05/06/walter-pichler-the-art-of-not-being-an-architect--.html (Accessed: 1/12/2025)

Figure 13. Fouillet, F. *Therme Vals* by Peter Zumthor (1996). [Photograph] Available at: https://divisare.com/projects/388269-peter-zumthor-morphosis-architects-thom-mayne-fabrice-fouillet-thermes-vals-at-7132-hotel (Accessed: 15/12/2025)

Figure 14. Zumthor, P. (1986-1988) *Therme Vals cross-section.* [Colored pencil and charcoal] Available at: https://www.park-books.com/en/product/peter-zumthor-therme-vals/623 (Accessed: 4/12/2025)

Figure 15. Zumthor, P. (1986-1988) *Therme Vals sketched plan.* [Colored pencil and charcoal] Available at: https://archeyes.com/peter-zumthors-therme-vals-sensory-architecture-in-an-alpine-retreat/ (Accessed 4/12/2025)

Figure 16. Brodsky, A and Utkin, I. (1989) *The Dome.* [Etching] Available at: https://www.tate.org.uk/art/artworks/brodsky-utkin-dome-p14574 (Accessed: 17/11/2025)

Figure 17. Brodsky, A and Utkin, I. *Columbarium Habitabile.* [Etching] Available at: https://www.tate.org.uk/art/artworks/brodsky-utkin-columbarium-habitabile-p14567 (Accessed: 17/11/2025)

Figure 18. Freidrich, C. (1810) *Abbey in the Oakwood.* [Oil on canvas] Available at: https://artsandculture.google.com/asset/abbey-among-oak-trees-caspar-david-friedrich/UAEmmuxqtNUt-g?hl=en (Accessed 1/12/2025)

Figure 19. Palmin, Y. *Vodka Pavilion* by Alexander Brodsky. [Photography] Available at: https://divisare.com/projects/322692-alexander-brodsky-yuri-palmin-vodka-pavilion (Accessed 19/11/2025)

Figure 20. Architecture-history,org. *Villa PO-2* by Alexander Brodsky. [Photography] Available at: https://architecture-history.org/architects/architects/BRODSKY/OBJ/2018,%20Villa%20PO-2,%20NIKOLA-LENIVETS,%20RUSSIA.html (Accessed: 3/12/2025)

Figure 21. Amoretti, A. (2024) *La Congiunta Museum (exterior)* by Peter Märkli (1992). [Photograph] Available at: https://divisare.com/projects/495023-peter-markli-aldo-amoretti-la-congiunta-museum (Accessed: 5/12/2025)

Figure 22. Amoretti, A. (2024) *La Congiunta Museum (interior)* by Peter Märkli (1992). [Photograph] Available at: https://divisare.com/projects/495023-peter-markli-aldo-amoretti-la-congiunta-museum (Accessed: 5/12/2025)

Paper architecture is often associated with unbuildable fantasies, in contrast to the heavy, earthbound seriousness of construction art and assembly known by the German *Baukunst.* This essay explores the nuanced relationship between the two, positioning them in dialogue rather than opposition. By introducing paper projects from Boullée and Piranesi through Archigram, Superstudio, and the late-Soviet work of Brodsky and Utkin, against an exploration of Baukunst through Bötticher, Semper, Goethe, and Frampton, the essay asks to what extent paper architecture can satisfy the demands of core form, material presence, and sensory experience. Through readings of Walter Pichler, Alexander Brodsky, Peter Zumthor, and Peter Märkli, it proposes that certain paper projects simulate tectonic weight and atmosphere so convincingly that they begin to behave as Baukunst on paper. At the same time, some built works adopt the melancholic themes more closely associated with paper architecture. In doing so, the essay aims to show that Baukunst isn't the negation of drawing, but is a standard against which both drawings and buildings can be measured.

Paper Architecture: Technological Optimism to Soviet Failure

Paper architecture has often arisen from sociopolitical situations that restrict creative freedom, leading some architects to channel their creativity into visionary projects meant to provoke a reaction rather than accommodate utility. While the term was coined in 1970s Soviet Russia, examples can still be traced back centuries prior, with the works of French architects such as Étienne-Louis Boullée's *Newton's Cenotaph* (1784), which was a memorial to Isaac Newton featuring a 150-meter large sphere resting on a circular base and surrounded by cypress trees (Figure 1). The illustration drawn with ink shows no inherent materiality of the sphere, but it does show the brickwork of the circular base on which the sphere is resting. A darker and more romantic example is Giovanni Battista Piranesi's *Carceri* drawings from the early 1770s, which depict labyrinth-like prisons composed of many architectural elements in a single drawing (Figure 2). These etchings have overlapping themes of romanticism and surrealism. They are both examples of dematerialization, with the former being a tectonic dematerialization featuring abstract masses and the latter being a romantic dissolution into infinity.

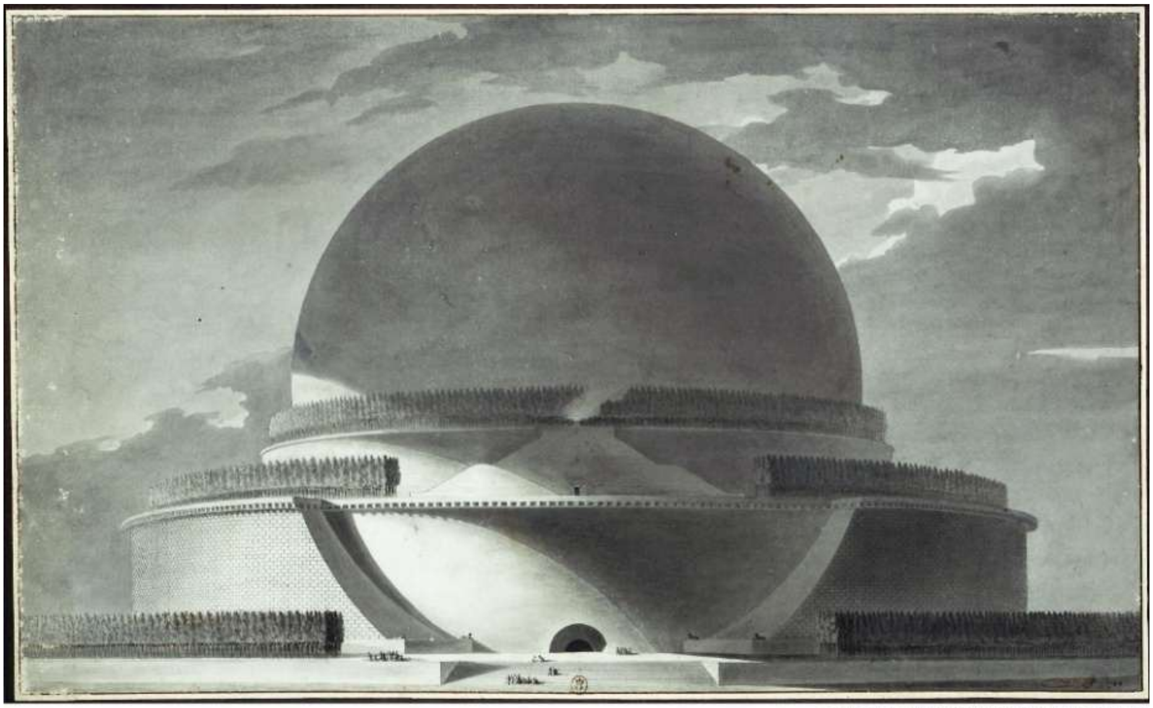

Figure 1. Newton’s Cenotaph (Étienne-Louis Boullée, 1784)

Figure 2. The Draw Bridge (Giovanni Battista Piranesi, 1750)

During the 1920s Soviet era, figures such as Vladimir Tatlin, Ivan Leonidov, and Iakov Chernikov proposed a distinct form of visionary architecture characterized by extreme optimism in the potential of emerging technology, such as steel, from the new machine age of the early 20th century. Their paper projects, such as Tatlin's Monument to the Third International or Leonidov's Lenin Institute, were sincere proposals to construct a socialist utopia.

This technological utopianism resurfaced in the West when post-war avant-garde groups such as 'Archigram' in the UK and 'Superstudio' in Italy began questioning the role of architecture by producing visionary projects not intended for construction. Archigram emerged from the Architectural Association in London in 1960. Their visionary projects focused on mobility and flexibility to meet users' needs. The drawings they produced show clear colossal utopian structures that roam, and in the case of *Walking City*, walk, vastly different settings. A similar theme is present with *Plug-in City*, which shows a utopian future of pre-fabricated homes (Figure 4). Archigram heavily leaned into the utopian technology by almost exclusively depicting forms with little to no materiality, similar to 'Superstudio' in Italy. Their *Continuous Monument* series shows these endless grid-like monolithic slabs and columns situated within existing cities but also in rural landscapes, which they illustrated using collages and hand drawings (Figure 3). These drawings pushed the non-materiality of paper architecture to its absolute limit; the slabs have no texture or materiality beyond their grids.

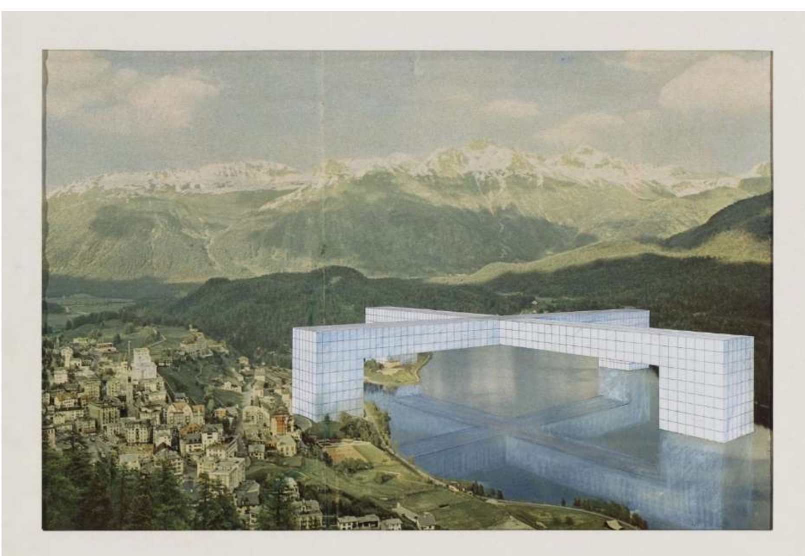

Figure 3. The Continuous Monument: St. Moritz Revisited (Superstudio, 1969)

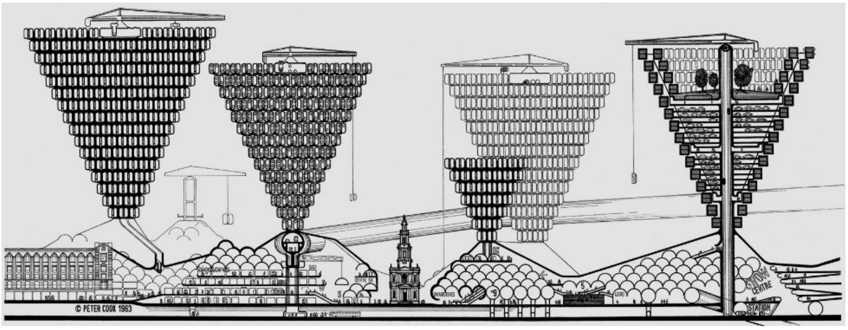

Figure 4. Plug-in City (Archigram, 1963)

While the 1920s and 60s used paper architecture to propose a new, optimistic future, the Soviet paper architects of the 1980s used it to mourn the failure of that dream. In the 1950s, Soviet Leader Nikita Khrutschev abolished Russia's Academy of Architecture, rejecting Stalinist ornamentation in favor of purely functional buildings (Khrupin, 2020); Architects faced a choice: either accept the lack of creative freedom and hold down a job, or look elsewhere. To bypass these restrictions, a group of Russian figures, including Alexander Brodsky, Ilya Utkin, Yuri Avvakumov, and others, began submitting proposals to international architectural competitions abroad, particularly in Japan, to secure prizes, exposure, and creative freedom.

If paper architecture encompasses these unbuilt visionary utopias, which carry themes of technological optimism, monumentality, or mourning loss in a distinctly visual format, what is its counterweight?; Baukunst: the art of building, construction, and assembly; the most physical and tectonic form of architecture. To truly understand the interplay between these two realms, it is essential to consider how they influence and inform each other. Paper architecture challenges the constraints of physicality and evokes emotional and intellectual responses, while Baukunst anchors architectural expression in the tangible and experiential. By comparing these two approaches, the dialogue between the imagined and the real becomes a fertile ground for exploring the potentialities and limitations inherent in each.

Origins of Baukunst: Materiality vs "Pure Form"

To understand why these drawings carry such weight, we must measure them against the strict German definition of Baukunst. Unlike the more commonly used *Architektur,* deriving from the Latin *architectura,* nowadays in Germany, 'Baukunst' is a compound of 'Bau' meaning building/construction, and 'Kunst' meaning art. It implies a more holistic building-art, grounded in the physical act of making; a concept defined by tectonics rather than by strictly visual composition (Trubiano, 2022, p.330).

The theoretical aspect of Baukunst was refined in the 19th century by Karl Bötticher. In *Die Tektonik der Hellenen (*The Tectonics of the Hellenes*)*, Bötticher lays the groundwork for two components of architecture: the *Kernform* (core form) and the *Kunstform* (art form). He states that the *Kernform* are all the parts that are structurally necessary for the building to stand while the Kunstform is the symbolic representation that covers the *Kernform*. However, the art form isn't strictly decorative; it's meant to articulate the mechanical forces that are active within the core form. For Bötticher, true Baukunst was the relationship of these two forces (Bötticher, 1852). This poses a direct challenge for paper architecture; if a project is lacking the *Kernform*, the physical reality of load, tension, and gravity, can it claim to be Baukunst when it is purely *Kunstform*?

Unlike Bötticher, Gottfried Semper grounded his definition of Baukunst in the material process rather than strictly the symbolic representation (Kunstform). Semper makes two distinctions regarding building: the stereotomic (the earthwork), which involves the piling of heavy masses and aspects of compression, and the tectonic (the frame), which involves the lightweight assembly of linear elements (Semper, 1851). This also provides a framework to stress-test paper architecture: does it remain purely visual, or can it simulate the weight of stereotomic earthwork?

However, the definition of Baukunst is further complicated because of the sensory demands. In 1795, Johann Wolfgang von Goethe, a prominent German romanticist literature writer, argued that architecture should go beyond strictly the visual: *"it might well be thought that, as a fine art, [the art of building] works for the eye alone, but it ought primarily—and very little attention is paid to this—to work for the sense of movement in the human body. When, in dancing, we move according to certain rules, we feel a pleasant sensation, and we ought to be able to arouse* *similar sensations in the person whom we lead blindfolded through a well-built house. The difficult and complicated doctrine of proportion, which enables the building and its various parts to have character comes in to play here"* (Goethe, cited in Trubiano, 2022, p.336).

While fine art relies on one sense of the human body to provoke a reaction, sight, building art relies on all senses. The temperature of the rooms, the breeze flowing through openings, the echoes of a long corridor, the roughness of the stone walls, the smoothness of the marble floors; all of these feelings, which are the backbone of building art, cannot be experienced in fine art. If we look at it through this lens, that for a work to constitute as Baukunst, it must be felt, and hence, built, then it is easy to say that paper architecture fails to meet the criteria. The counterargument could be that architecture (and Baukunst) relies on multiple media: sketches, drawings, models, and the project's narrative and soul. That narrative relies on methods of expression; paper architecture's visionary drawings activate an emotional response that built work struggles to do. It's one thing to experience a building by inhabiting it, but it's wildly different seeing the architect's rendition and representation of it.

Walter Pichler: Enclosure on Paper through Earthwork

On paper

Walter Pichler's drawings live in a world between the speculative realm of paper architecture and the material grounding of Baukunst. While his range of work includes strange subterranean structures, sculptures, and wearable objects, his graphic representations often align more with the materiality and tectonics of Baukunst. Pichler is an interesting character because, while he is frequently situated within paper architecture primarily because of his *Underground City* and *Compact City* series from the 1960s, he is often closer to Baukunst, especially in his later work. He bridges the gap between the two very delicately. The order of his work is a journey of his work transitioning from the dematerialized forms, such as Superstudio's *Continuous Monument*, but then moving to wearable objects, which are akin to the technological themes of Archigram, then later in his career leaning into more poetic and atmospheric drawings and structures, which by today's standards would be prime examples of Baukunst.

Pichler's *Prototypes* series, in the late 1960s, questions the need for buildings in architecture. The most well-known of these is the *TV Helmet*, a white capsule helmet fitted with a TV screen. Pichler argues that in the age of media, architecture is no longer about stone and timber, but rather a digital feed (Figure 5). This is a critical rupture in terms of Baukunst, as defined by Goethe and later Frampton. Baukunst relies on complete and active sensory engagement of the body. Pichler disrupts this connection, reducing architecture to strictly sight and image. The helmet looks like something that would be featured in an Archigram drawing, perhaps pre-fitted to all the dwellings of both the *Walking City* and the *Plug-in City*. This niche of dematerialization is relatively common for the post-war era. For example, Reyner Banham's *A Home Is Not a House* (1965) argues that technological advancements would make the traditional house obsolete, as its services could be independent of the structure. He shows this through a series of drawings by François Dallegret, one of which depicts the future home as an unrendered mass taking the shape of the rock it rests on, with the services in the middle and the occupants around it (Figure 6). Although Pichler's helmet was built, the drawings are paper architecture pushed to its limits; the tectonics are rendered obsolete, the architecture is stripped down to strictly the virtual, which, in Kenneth Frampton's *Studies in Tectonic Culture*, he argues that the dematerialization "*leads to a phenomenological and cultural devaluation of the tectonic*". He attributes the rampant dematerialization to a combination of technological advancements and a cultural shift towards imagery over material reality (Frampton, 1996, p.381).

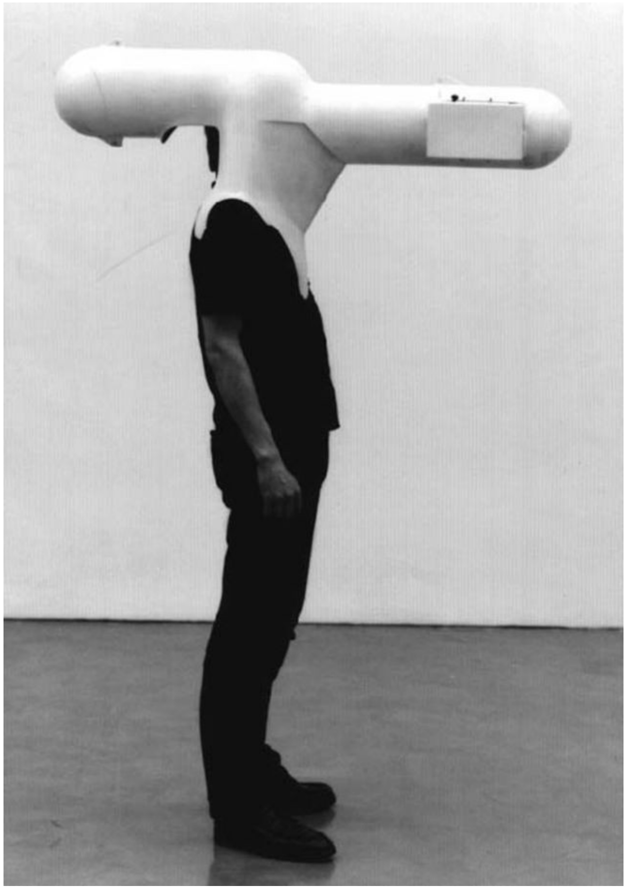

Figure 5. TV Helmet, Physical prototype. (Walter Pichler, 1967)

Figure 6. A Home is not a House (Reyner Banham and François Dallegret, 1965)

Unlike his TV Helmet, *Underground City* (1962-1963) is a series of drawings depicting monolithic structures, primarily underground but also partially above the surface. The drawings portray the city as a lost civilization, buried in time (Figures 7 and 8); they constitute a clear rejection of the lightweight, transparent architecture that dominated the 1960s. Rather than proposing a building sitting atop the landscape, he subtracts from it, like a negative Baukunst, carved from solid mass. Through his graphic style of dense shading and hatching, Pichler doesn't directly render the materiality of the structure, yet it still reads as a nuclear apocalypse concrete bunker. Even though this was never meant to be built, Pichler still respects the constraints of the landscape; he intensifies the compressive nature of the building, which provides distinct stereotomic qualities that would, in Semper's terms, constitute true 'earthwork'.

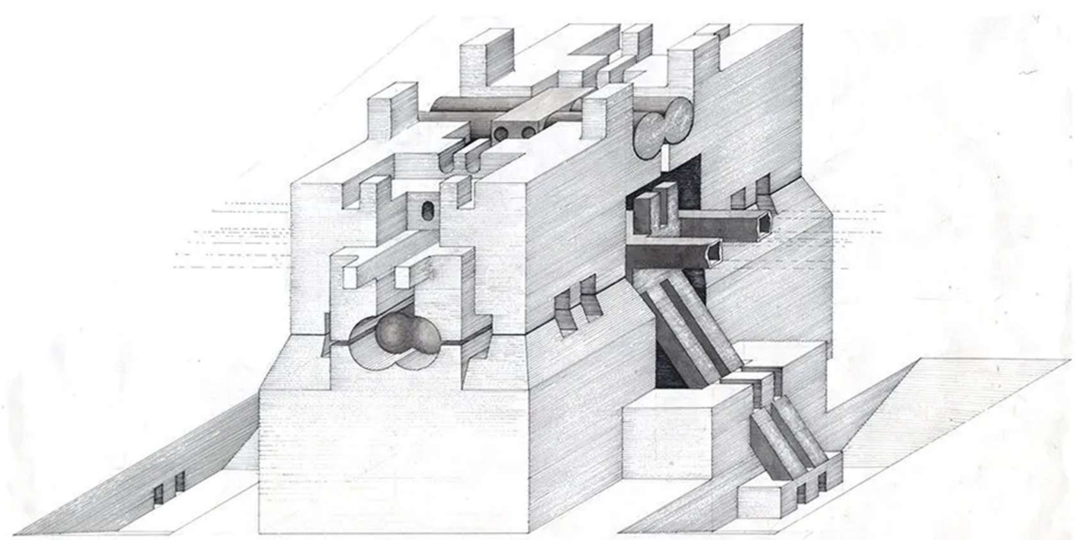

Figure 7. Underground Building, Isometric (Walter Pichler, 1963)

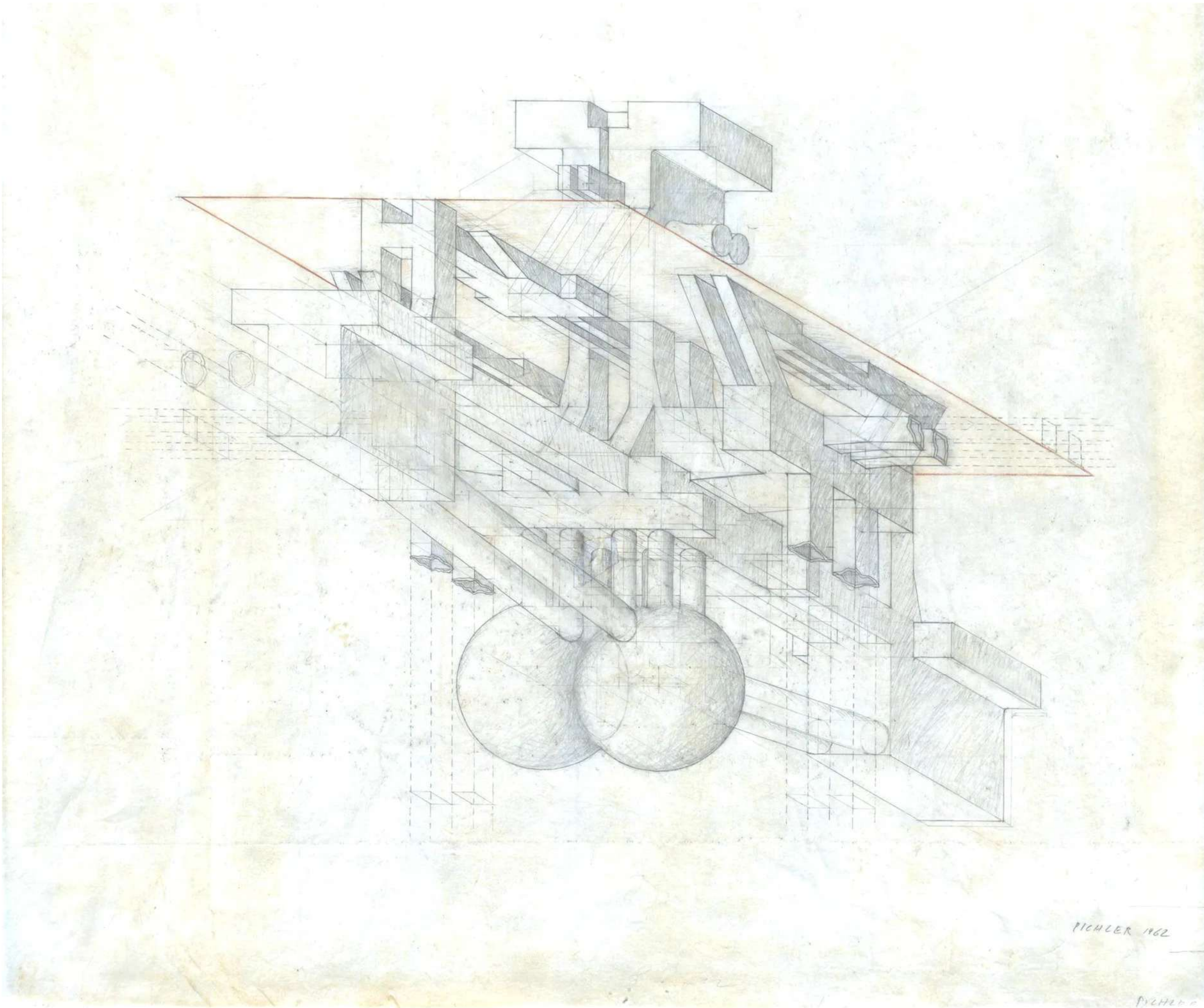

Figure 8. Nucleus of an Underground Building (Walter Pichler, 1962)

Compact City (1963) is similar to *Underground City*. It is also a radical urban proposal; while his drawings differ from his model, they both convey a sense of enormous scale, with one cylindrical tower serving as the community's circulation and services, while the adjacent tower connected to it houses the community (Figure 9). Unlike Archigram's *Plug-in City*, which proposes infinite expansion, Pichler's drawings are grounded, finite, and absolute. In the context of Baukunst, *Compact City* is contradictory; on the one hand, it relies on technological advancements such as *Plug-in City* rather than traditional building craft. On the other hand, it still adheres to Goethe's belief that a building should be a unique vessel for experience. While the illustration style is similar to Superstudio's dematerialization, the inherent architectural substance is stereotomic.

The thick walls still provide clear visual and acoustic isolation, prioritizing the atmosphere of the inner spaces over the urban context. Pichler realized that for architecture to have meaning, it must protect and value its inhabitants; this philosophy eventually led him to abandon paper architecture and move into a realm of more ritualistic, heavy construction projects, such as his farm buildings in St. Martin, in quite a paradoxical fashion; his explorations with these dematerialized forms for isolation led him to his tectonic built work.

Figure 9. Compact City, Physical model. (Walter Pichler, 1963)

Built Work

As stated earlier, Pichler is an interesting character because he transitions from these utopian paper projects to humble, small, tectonic buildings. One of his most well-known buildings is his *House next to the Smithy* in Eggental, Italy (1999-2002); a quaint stone building with a glass roof facing a stone smithy situated in a valley. This project is his Baukunst response to his earlier work, particularly his *TV Helmet*.

Figure 10. House next to the Smithy, Exterior (Photo: Domusweb, 2002. Architect: Walter Pichler, 1999-2002)

The drawings he made of the building are wildly different from his earlier ones; they rely heavily on color to convey the materials and the proposal's overall atmosphere. The axonometric of the concrete foundations is colored to show the form of the foundation and slab, the shadows, and the texture of the concrete as it's been cut, with the rest of the page colored red to contrast the grey of the concrete (Figure 11). The drawing, like his drawings of *Underground City,* has stereotomic qualities of 'earth work'. The elevation shows the stone work of the walls, the rocks resting on the ground, and even the texture of the earth itself (Figure 12). This is unlike any of Archigram, Superstudio, Piranesi, Brodksy, or even Pichler's own earlier drawings. The finished product is quintessentially tectonic: exposed steel roof trusses resting atop the stone wall, the wooden floor meeting the plaster-rendered interior, and the exposed junction of the exterior stone meeting the interior plaster.

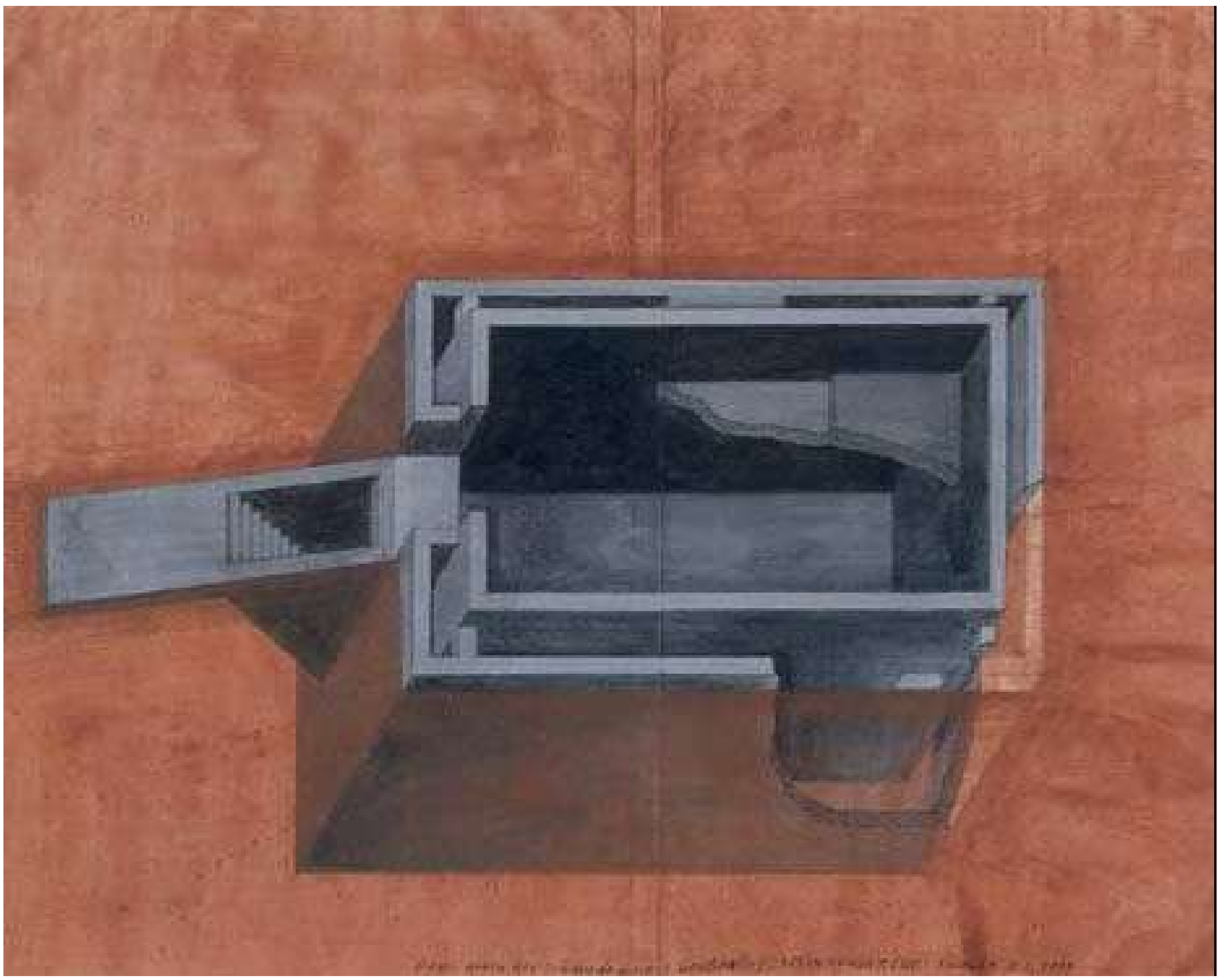

Figure 11. Drawing of concrete foundations (Walter Pichler, 1999-2002)

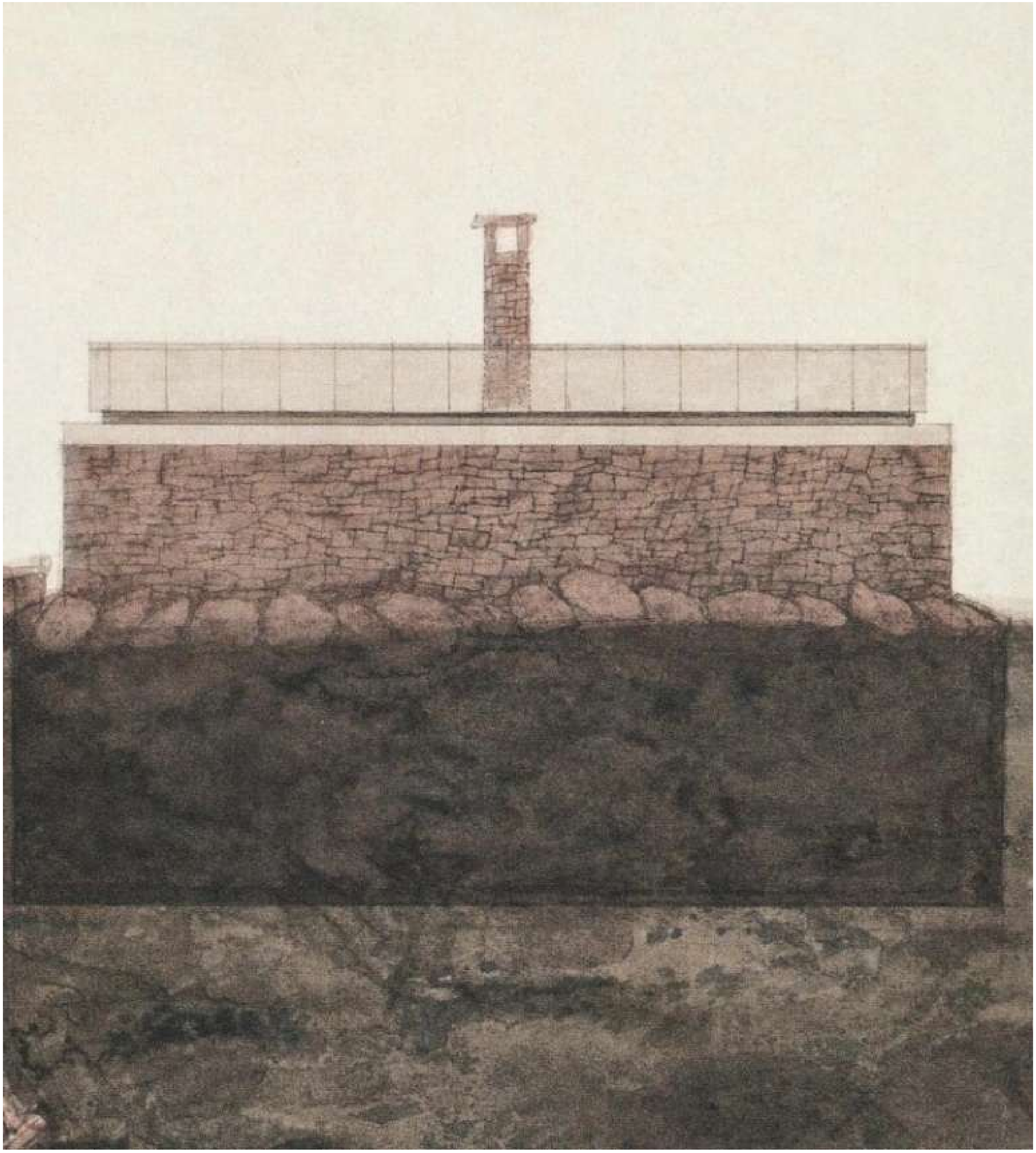

Figure 12. Elevation of Pichler's Eggental House (Walter Pichler, 1999-2002)

Peter Zumthor: Materialisation of Atmospheres

The tension between the imagined and the built isn't strictly polar opposite; If Pichler's *Underground City* simulates the weight of the earth on paper, the built work of Peter Zumthor resurrects its physical body through the materials. He explicitly treats the building as a body, where in his book *Atmospheres* (2006, p.23)*,* he says, "*The body! Not the idea of the body - the body itself! A body that can touch me*." Zumthor shows that the atmospheric themes usually reserved for paper architecture: mystery, gloom, silence, mourning, isolation, etc, can be translated into built work provided that adherence to the principles of tectonics is respected.

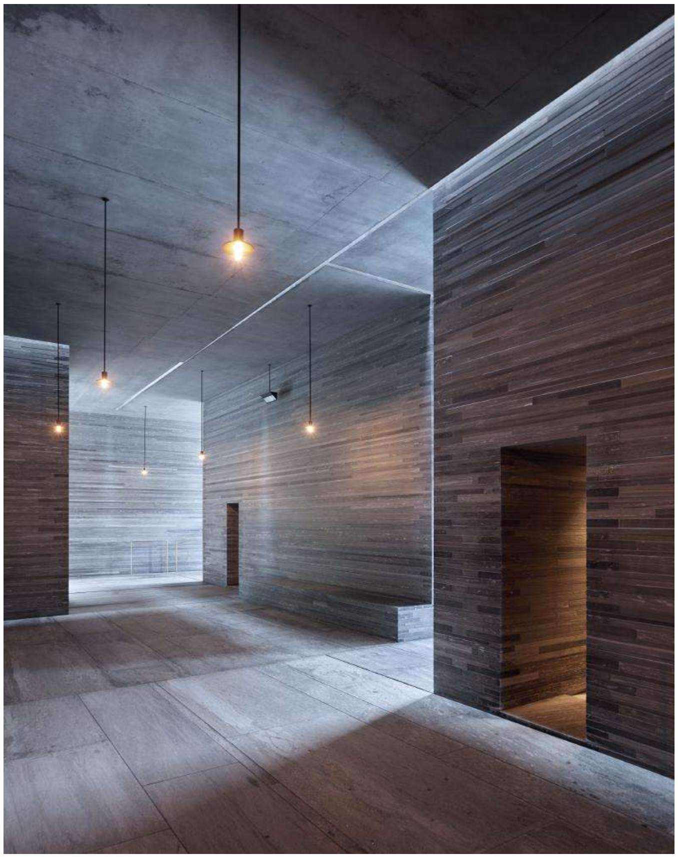

Figure 13. Therme Vals (Photo: Fabrice Fouillet. Architect: Peter Zumthor, 1996)

This is most evident in Zumthor's *Therme Vals* (1996): similar to Pichler's *Underground City* (Figures 7 and 8), where he carves into the landscape rather than resting atop it, Zumthor executes the same principle in reality. The building is made of local quartzite slabs with a form akin to a geometric cave system of the mountain. Zumthor fulfills Goethe's criteria of Baukunst; if one were to be blindfolded, the architecture would still be felt through the humidity of the air, the acoustics of the quartzite slabs, the temperature differences of the thermal baths, and the tactile qualities of the stone walls. His drawings also show this; the charcoal sketches focus more on light, shadow, and the overall mood he is trying to achieve (Figures 14 and 15). He constructs the *Kunstform* on paper before constructing the structural *Kernform*. Where Archigram and Metabolism propose lightweight, flexible structures, Zumthor pursues dense, permanent ones. In *Atmospheres* (2006, p.47), Zumthor describes the tension between a building's exterior and interior. He says, “*I own a castle. That’s where I live and that is the façade I present to the outside world. The façade says: I am, I can, I want… The façade also says: but I am not going to show you everything*.” This comparison captures the tension between paper architecture and Baukunst well: paper architecture says, "I am, I can, I want." Baukunst says, “I am not going to show you everything.”

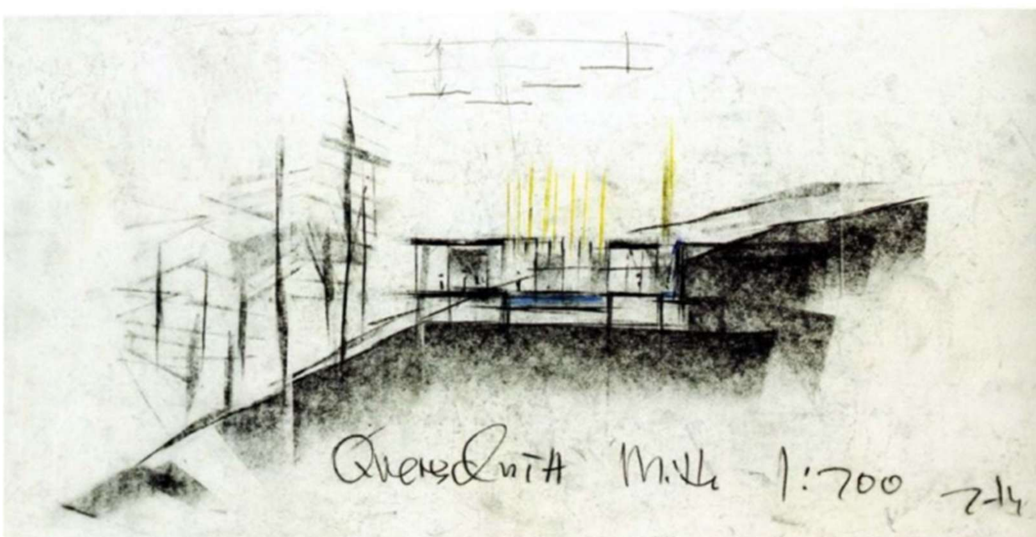

Figure 14. Charcoal-sketched section of *Therme Vals* (Peter Zumthor, 1986-1988)

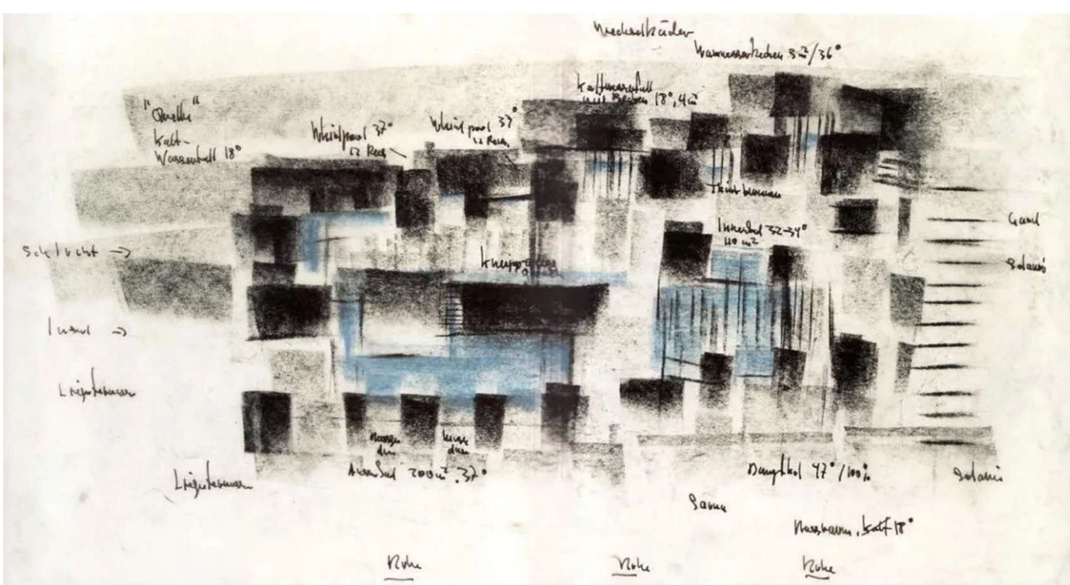

Figure 15. Charcoal-sketched plan of *Therme Vals* (Peter Zumthor, 1986-1988)

Brodsky and Utkin: Satirical Melancholy

On paper

Unlike Pichler's machine prototypes of human isolation, Brodsky's paper architecture yearns for preservation. Amid the Soviet demolition of Moscow and the introduction of soulless prefabrication, Brodsky's etchings mourn lost heritage, evoking Piranesi-like ruins rather than futuristic utopias, but also serve as satirical criticism of the earlier, sincere 1920s visionary architecture. Collaborating with Ilya Utkin, they resisted prefabrication speeds through metal plate etchings, a slow and laborious craft. They don't read as drawings where the tectonics or construction method can be interpreted to show how it could be built, unlike some of Pichler's drawings. They are meant to exist for the sake of existing and reminiscing.

Yet, the etchings still vividly convey materiality. For example, in *The Dome* (1989), thin wooden columns and beams are stacked within a constrained dome, suggesting imminent collapse (Figure 16). The tectonic fragility mimics Baukunst's material expression without any sense of construction or of traditionally accepted tectonic methods, directly challenging whether Baukunst requires physical realization or if paper suffices. This rejection aligns with Piranesi's *Carceri* drawings (Figure 1); like Brodsky, Piranesi's drawings are not proposals but rather grotesque environments of illogical, labyrinthine spaces. The accumulation of ink in the etchings acts as a form of paper stereotomy; it creates a dense pressure of materials without the implicit load.

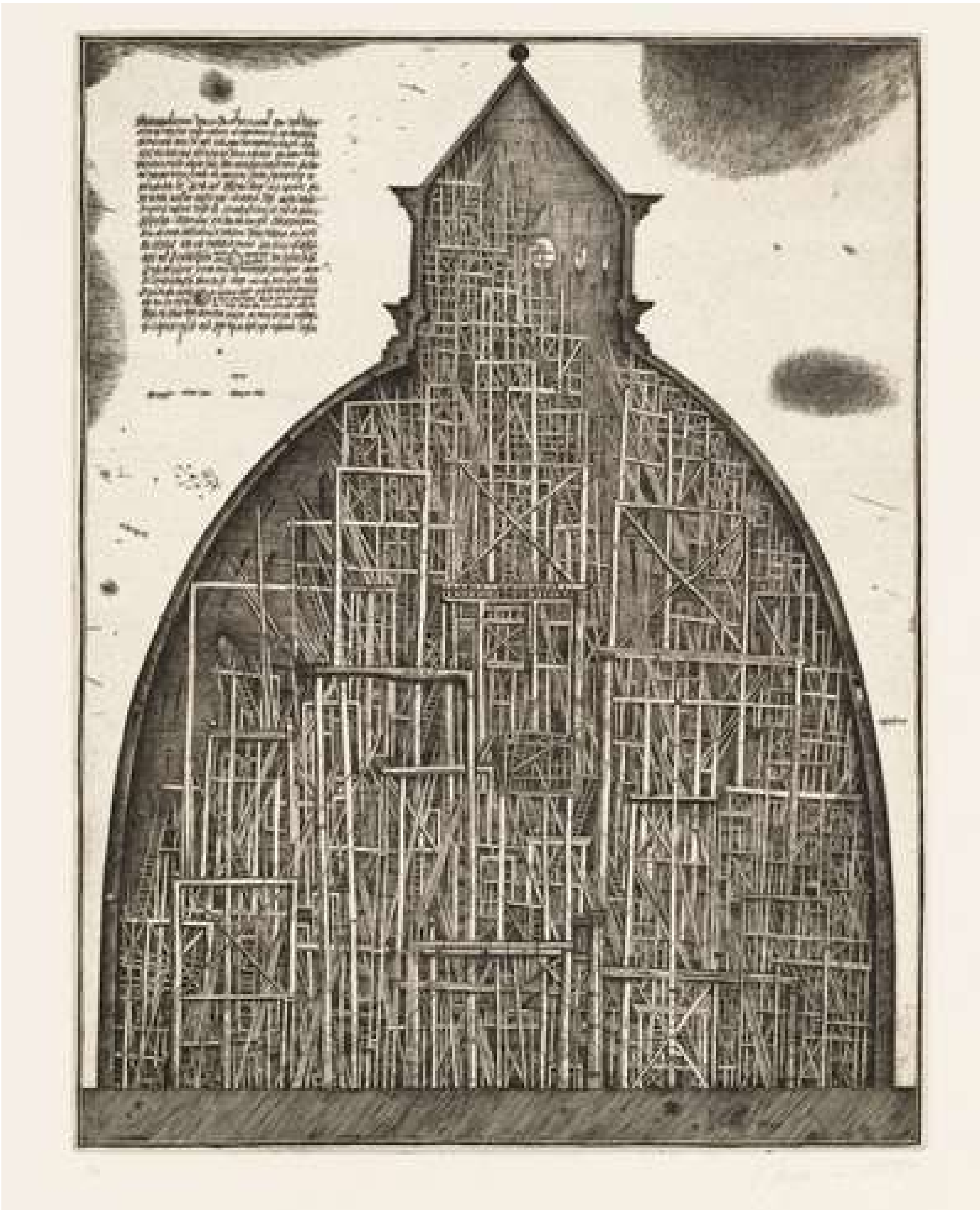

Figure 16. The Dome, Etching (Alexander Brodsky and Ilya Utkin, 1989)

While Pichler's earlier work explores themes of timeless isolation, Brodsky and Utkin's etchings evoke a melancholic past. The work fits the aesthetics of picturesque ruins; this is evident in *Columbarium Habitabile*, which shows different buildings shelved in a grid, up for display, with observers at a scale with the buildings (Figure 17). The etching mourns the loss of Soviet heritage, capturing a deep sense of gloom and somberness, reminiscent of the romantic ruins of

Casper David Friedrich's painting *Abbey in the Oakwood* (Figure 18). Frampton pushes back against treating architecture solely as image or scenography; he argues that the "*earthbound nature of building*" is just as much about construction, materiality, and gravity as it is about the visual (1996, p.2). Brodsky, in an ironic fashion, is drawing scenographic and picturesque but to save the tectonic soul. At a time when the prior Soviet visionaries' works hadn't come to fruition and had been replaced by mass-produced prefabrication, he uses scenography to mourn the failure of the tectonic potential of Soviet architecture. By stripping away the glamour of architectural fantasies, it turns into a satirical sadness; the buildings on display are glimpses into what could've been.

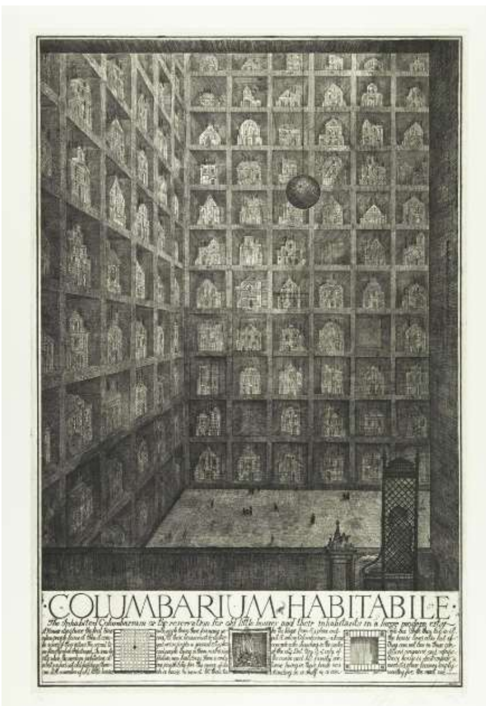

Figure 17. Columbarium Habitabile (Alexander Brodsky and Ilya Utkin, 1989)

Figure 18. Abbey in the Oakwood. (Casper David Freidrich, 1810)

This contrast is intensified when considering the context of these dark and gloomy etchings; as mentioned earlier, they were submitted to architectural competitions, particularly in Japan. The Japanese scene, driven by the economic boom, allowed them to create bold, high-tech, and postmodern buildings such as the *Nakagin Capsule Tower* by Metabolism, which consisted of small capsules interconnected into two central cores, and *The Ark* by Shin Takamatsu. This dental clinic features a fortress-like, industrial façade that resembles a metallic sculpture perched atop the building. These Japanese projects praised and utilized the technological advancements of the time, yet Brodsky and Utkin were sending these dark, dense etchings depicting melancholic, dystopian spaces and structures.

Built Work

Brodsky's transition to built work differs from Pichler's; while Pichler's heavy tectonics of the earth, stone, and concrete, Brodsky retains the artistic and exhibitionist qualities of his etchings. Moving away from the purely visual, he began constructing small temporary pavilions that act as inhabitable drawings. These pavilions, often built from scavenged materials, keep the fragile qualities of his etchings. Just like the etchings, they're not designed for utility, but as poetic objects inserted into the landscape. The transition from paper isn't the abandonment of his earlier themes but a manifestation of them, unlike Pichler.

Some of his built works still carry melancholic satire, like his etchings that, in an ironic fashion, mock and mourn the loss of the visionary proposals of the 1920s mentioned earlier. His *Vodka Pavilion* (2003) materializes this satire (Figure 19). Built from scavenged white window frames saved from demolished 19th-century Soviet buildings, the pavilion is a fragile and opaque temple for collective drinking, a distinctly Russian ritual. Where his 1920s predecessors envisioned using new materials of the machine era, Brodsky uses old, recycled, dirty windows and timber to preserve memory. While the building is technically functional, it's functional in the most absurd sense. This refusal to build functional or clean buildings shapes his tectonic resistance in his later work.

Figure 19. Vodka Pavilion, Exterior (Photo: Yuri Palmin. Architect: Alexander Brodsky, 2003)

This is evident in his *Villa PO-2* (2017)*,* where he reuses Soviet-era concrete fence panels known as ‘PO-2’ (Figure 20). The villa is divided into two layers: the concrete-panelled exterior and the wooden interior. The building's proportions are dictated by the prefabricated panels, resulting in a very compact interior. Before adding the wooden interior, Brodsky turned the concrete-panelled exterior into an exhibition featuring a tree growing from within the building. It acts as a physical realization of his earlier etchings, particularly *The Dome*, where themes of memory, nostalgia, and loss are crammed into a space. In this case, the thin wooden scaffolding squeezed into the dome becomes the tree squeezed into the Soviet-era concrete-panelled box. In both instances, Brodsky finds materiality and poetics in the abandoned.

Figure 20. Villa Po-2, Exterior (Photo: architecture-history.org Architect: Alexander Brodsky, 2017)

Peter Märkli: Kernform as a House for Art

A counterpart to Brodsky’s concrete ruin is found in Peter Märkli’s *La Congiunta House for Sculptures* (1992). Like Brodsky’s *Villa PO-2,* the building is an extreme reduction of architecture to its bare structure; it is a windowless concrete building without electricity, heating, or insulation, with the only source of light provided sparingly through skylights (Figures 21 and 22). The ritualistic resistance goes beyond the interior. Situated along a stretch of road, the building denies visitors a clear path; it stands as an object to be sought out. Unlike scenographic architecture, which is designed for immediate visual consumption and comfort, *La Congiunta* demands physical effort. The visitor has to locate the keys from the nearby village and traverse the unpaved ground to enter.

Housing the sculptures of Hans Josephsohn, the building doesn’t act as a gallery in the traditional sense, but rather like a bunker for art that prioritizes art over the comfort of visitors. The building's form transforms the circulation into a ritualistic linear path, with changes in ceiling heights between rooms that compress and release the visitors. After reaching the final room, the same path is taken in reverse. In the context of Bötticher, Märkli challenges the separation of *Kernform* and *Kunstform.* He embraces the raw structural core and pushes it into the status of art through what Goethe called the "Doctrine of proportion." There is no physical or symbolic separation between the walls that hold up the building and what visitors can touch; the concrete walls are the artistic finish that gives the building its character. It sits somewhere between Baukunst and paper architecture; a built structure with the poetic stubbornness of Brodsky.

Figure 21. La Congiunta Museum, Exterior (Photo: Aldo Amoretti, 2024; Architect: Peter Markli, 1992)

Figure 22. La Congiunta Museum, Interior (Photo: Aldo Amoretti, 2024; Architect: Peter Markli, 1992)

The cases of Pichler, Zumthor, Brodsky, and Märkli show that the boundary between paper architecture and Baukunst is far more porous than a simple opposition of “real” and “imaginary” suggests. Pichler’s *Underground City and Compact City* simulate stereotomic mass and bodily compression on paper, before his Eggental house translates those graphic atmospheres into literal stone, concrete, and steel. This contrasts with Zumthor’s *Therme Vals*, which demonstrates that the supposedly “paper” qualities of mystery, melancholy, and isolation can be achieved tectonically, through quartzite, water, and carefully staged thresholds, fulfilling Goethe’s demand that architecture address the whole body rather than the eye alone. Brodsky and Utkin, by contrast, preserve tectonic memory through etching, turning scenographic ruins into a satirical defence of architecture’s material soul, while Brodsky’s pavilions and *Villa PO-2* only partly surrender their paper fragility when built. Märkli’s *La Congiunta* pushes in the opposite direction, stripping away *Kunstform* to produce a bunker-like *Kernform* that behaves like a constructed drawing. While Frampton is clearly opposed to scenography and the dematerialization of forms, there are layers to it; for architects such as Brodsky, the drawing isn’t a retreat from reality; it’s his form of resistance. For Pichler, it’s his way of exploring spaces and methods of isolation within inhabitation. Taken together, these examples suggest that Baukunst is not guaranteed by construction nor excluded by paper: it emerges wherever form, material, and atmosphere conspire to make architecture both physically convincing and ethically self-aware, whether on the page or in the ground.

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